PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Syllable Rules #4: The Suffix Rule

A suffix is the "tail" of a word that can be added to the end of a word to elaborate on the meaning. "tion" is an example of a suffix as "tion" can be added to many words: "de**TEN**tion, a**FFEC**tion, re**LA**tion." Suffixes are usually unstressed, and the stress is generally placed on the syllable **just before** the suffix.

AGE	dis-**cour-**age	per-**cent-**age	ad-**vant-**age
ANCE/ENCE	ac-**quaint-**ance	o-ver-a-**bund-**ance	in-de-**pend-**ence
TED	un-ex-**pec-**ted	pre-**sen-**ted	sub-**mit-**ted
ENCY	in-con-**sist-**en-cy	com-**plac-**en-cy	in-ef-**fici-**en-cy
ENT	in-de-**pend-**ent	cor-re-**spond-**ent	in-can-**desc-**ent
EOUS	cour-**ag**-eous	si-mul-**tan**-eous	ad-van-**tag**-eous
IAL	con-se-**quent**-ial	fi-**nanc**-ial	ar-ti-**fic**-ial
IAN	ve-ge-**tar**-ian	ma-the-ma-**tic**-ian	am-**phib**-ian
IC	pho-to-**graph**-ic	i-**co**n-ic	**trag**-ic
ICAL	**Log**-ic-al	e-co-**nom**-ic-al	ster-e-o-**typ**-ic-al
IFY	**just**-i-fy	e-**lectr**-i-fy	ob-**ject**-i-fy
IOUS	har-**mon**-i-ous	**glor**-i-ous	con-sci-**ent**-i-ous
ITY	com-**mod**-i-ty	**DIG**-ni-ty	re-spec-ti-**bil**-i-ty
GRAPHY/PHER	pho-**to**-gra-phy	ge-**o**-gra-phy	bi-**o**-gra-phy
SION	com-**mi**-ssion	per-**mi**-ssion	**pa**-ssion
TION	ad-min-i -**stra**-tion	re-cre-**a**-tion	re-ex-a-mi-**na**-tion
UAL	un-**us**-u-al	in-te-**llect**-u-al	mul-ti-**ling**-u-al
LOGY	psy-**cho**-lo-gy	the-**o**-lo-gy	mi-cr-bi-**o**-lo-gy
METRY/METER	ge-**o**-me-try	tri-go-**no**-me-try	**sy**-mme-try
LOGIST	i-de-**o**-lo-gist	psy-**cho**-lo-gist	an-thro-**po**-lo-gist
ISH	es-**TA**-blish	re-**FIN**-nish	dis-**TING**-uish
IBLE	in-**cred**-i-ble	in-com-pre-**hens**-i-ble/**terr**-i-ble	
MENT	co-**mmit**-ment	en-ter-**tain**-ment	en-**gage**-ment

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There are a few Suffixes that do **not** affect stress:

ABLE	de-**MON**-stra-ble	un-**break-**a-ble	**PLEA**-su-re-able
HOOD	**PA**-rent-hood	**NEIGH**-bour-hood	**WO**-man-hood
NESS	a-**TTRAC**-tive-ness	**HA**-ppi-ness	**FRIEND**-li-ness
ISM	i-**DEAL**-ism	**FE**-men-ism	**TERR**-or-ism

Three syllable words ending in “er” and “ly.”

Words that have three syllables and end in “-er” or “-ly” usually have stress on the first syllable.

Examples:

OR-der-ly
QUI-et-ly
Ha-ppi-ly
MA-na-ger
O-pe-ner
Car-pen-ter